
PHYSICAL EDUCATION AND SPORTS

Participating in sports improves physical fitness by supporting cardiovascular health, muscular strength, and overall bodily coordination. It enhances emotional well-being by releasing endorphins. This module focuses on the importance of sports, their classification, and sportsmanship and etiquette.

Importance of Sports

According to **Article XIV, Section 19** of the **1987 Philippine Constitution**:

“The State [to] promote physical education and encourage sports programs, league competitions, and amateur sports, including training for international competitions to foster self-discipline, teamwork, and excellence for the development of a healthy and alert citizenry. All educational institutions shall undertake regular sports activities throughout the country in cooperation with athletic clubs and other sectors.”

Furthermore, **Republic Act No. 5708**, known as **The Schools Physical Education and Sports Development Act of 1969**, provided for:

“An integrated physical education and sports development program in all schools in the Philippines (Section 2)... the goal is to instill in young citizens a proper appreciation of the importance of physical development hand in hand with the mental development in individual and social activities (1) and the provision for “a well-rounded physical education program must be addressed to physical growth, social training, and personal discipline for all pupils and students as well as superior athletic achievement for those who are psychologically inclined and physically gifted (2).”

Classification of Sports

Sports cultivate essential social bonds and teamwork skills that structurally benefit individuals across all areas of civil life.

- a. **Individual sports** are activities where a single athlete **competes independently** against opponents or against a personal milestone. Performance is based entirely on the **athlete's own ability, preparation, and decision-making**. Outcomes are usually measured against other individuals or against objective standards such as time or a **score**.

Advantages of Individual Sports

Individual sports allow athletes to **fully control** their **performance** and **strategy** during competition. They develop **strong discipline, focus, and self-motivation**, as success depends solely on the athlete. They also provide clear feedback on **personal strengths** and **weaknesses**.

Disadvantages of Individual Sports

Athletes experience **high pressure** because all responsibility rests on them alone. There is **no teammate support to rely on** when making mistakes or facing challenges. **Losses** can feel **more personal** since outcomes are entirely individual.

Examples:

- **Track and Field (solo events)** includes disciplines such as the **100m sprint**, **long jump**, **shot put**, and **high jump**, in which athletes compete solely on personal merit.
 - **Swimming** is competitive individual racing across various strokes, such as **freestyle**, **backstroke**, **breaststroke**, and **butterfly**.
 - **Gymnastics** includes events such as the **vault**, **balance beam**, and **floor exercises**, where athletes are judged on their individual technical execution and artistry.
 - **Golf** is a precision **club-and-ball sport** in which individuals navigate a course in the fewest strokes possible.
 - **Archery** is a test of **accuracy** and **composure** in which a single competitor **shoots arrows** at a **stationary target**.
 - **Figure skating** consists of routines set to music and judged on technical difficulty and grace.
- b. **Dual sports** involve **two pairs of athletes** competing directly against one another, requiring synchronized physical effort and **tactical coordination**. Each athlete tries to outperform the other through **skill**, **strategy**, and **reaction**. The competition is **continuous** and **highly interactive**.

Advantages of Dual Sports

Dual sports develop **strong focus** and **quick decision-making** against a single opponent. Athletes improve their ability to **read** and **adapt** to an **opponent's strategy** in real time. The structure is simple, making it easier to understand rules and gameplay.

Disadvantages of Dual Sports

The constant direct opposition creates **significant mental pressure**. There is **limited tactical variety** compared to team-based games. Athletes must maintain **high concentration** throughout the entire match without support.

Examples:

- **Tennis** is a **racket sport** played **one-on-one (singles)** or **two-on-two (doubles)** across a central net.
- **Badminton** is a fast-paced sport in which pairs or individual players use **lightweight rackets** to hit a **shuttlecock** over a high net.
- **Table Tennis** is a high-speed sport played with **small paddles** and a **lightweight ball** on a table divided by a net.

- **Pickleball** is a **paddle sport**, either **one-on-one** or **two-on-two**, where players **use paddles** to hit a **perforated ball** over a net on a **badminton-sized court**.
- c. **Team sports** are games where **groups of players work together** to compete **against another group**. Success depends on **cooperation**, **communication**, and **shared strategy** among all members. Each player usually has a **specific role** that contributes to the team's performance.

Advantages of Team Sports

Team sports **build communication** and **cooperation skills** among players. **Responsibility** is shared, reducing pressure on a single individual. They also **encourage leadership** and **social development** through **group interaction**.

Disadvantages of Team Sports

Performance can be affected by **weak** or **uncooperative teammates**. Conflicts may arise due to **differences** in **roles** or **attitudes**. Some players may receive **less involvement** depending on team structure and strategy.

Examples:

- **Basketball** is a game played by **two teams of five players**, where points are scored by **shooting a ball** through an **elevated hoop**.
 - **Soccer** is a sport played by **two opposing teams of eleven players** who attempt to score by **kicking the ball** into the **opponent's goal** without using their hands.
 - **Volleyball** is a sport in which **two teams of six players** use their **hands and arms** to **strike a ball back and forth** over a high net.
 - **Baseball** is a **bat-and-ball game** played between **two teams of nine players** who take turns **batting** and **fielding**.
 - **Ice hockey** is a **fast-paced, physical sport** played on ice, in which **two teams of six players** use sticks to shoot a puck into a net.
 - **Rugby** is a **contact team sport** involving **carrying, passing, and kicking** an **oval-shaped ball** to score points against an opposing team.
- d. **Combative sports** involve **direct physical confrontation** between **two opponents** under **strict rules**. The goal is to **outscore** or **overpower the opponent** using **controlled techniques**. **Safety regulations** are enforced to reduce unnecessary harm.

Advantages of Combative Sports

Combative sports build **strong physical fitness, endurance, and strength**. They develop **discipline, self-control, and mental toughness under pressure**. They also teach **practical self-defense skills** within a structured environment.

Disadvantages of Combative Sports

There is a **higher risk of injury** due to **direct physical contact**. Training requires **strict discipline** and **proper supervision** to ensure safety. The **physical and mental demands** can be **intense** for many participants.

Examples:

- **Boxing** is a **combat sport** in which **two athletes** wear **protective gloves** and **throw punches** at each other within a **roped square ring**.
- **Judo** is a **martial art** focused primarily on **throws, takedowns, and submission grappling techniques**.
- **Wrestling** is a **physical competition** involving **grappling techniques** such as **clinch fighting, throws, and pins**.
- **Taekwondo** is a **martial art** heavily characterized by its emphasis on **fast, high, and spinning kicking techniques**.
- **Fencing** is a **tactical combat sport** using **blunted swords (foil, épée, or saber)** to score points through **quick, precise touches**.

Sportsmanship and Etiquette

Sportsmanship refers to **playing within the rules** and **understanding** and using **sports etiquette**. It is **playing fairly** in the spirit of the game, **showing respect** to **opponents** and **graciousness** in **both victory and defeat**.

Etiquette refers to the **unwritten rules or customs** that uphold respect and fairness. These help people to play in the **'spirit of the game.'** They often require players to take an active approach to **respect** and **fairness**, not just to avoid breaking the rules. This practice requires athletes to maintain **emotional control, accept official rulings gracefully, and treat opponents with genuine dignity**.

Example: A tennis player clapping for an opponent's exceptionally placed shot or voluntarily admitting when an opponent's ball landed inside the boundary line.

Safety Precautions

Playing sports benefits children and adults. It has **physical** and **psychological benefits** which can improve **physical coordination, fitness, and self-esteem**. Sports also teach important lessons about **teamwork** and **self-discipline**. However, children are vulnerable to sports injuries because their bodies are still growing and their coordination is still developing.

Most sports injuries occur due to the following:

- Lack of education and awareness about safety precautions and potential injury.
- Inappropriate or insufficient equipment.
- Poorly conditioned players.

These are general safety precautions to help prevent sports injuries:

- Wear appropriate safety gear and equipment.
- The playing environment should be well-lit and appropriate for the sport.
- Enforce safety rules.
- Players should stay hydrated during and after sports activities.
- Take breaks during training and games to prevent overuse injuries.

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